



CYBERSECURITY INCIDENT REPORT

IR-2026-002 | SSH Brute Force Detection

Security Monitoring | Threat Detection | Incident Response

Analyst	Clinton Etienne
Environment	Wazuh SIEM Ubuntu Server Kali Linux VirtualBox Home Lab
Severity	Medium
Status	Closed
MITRE ATT&CK	T1110.001 - Password Guessing

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Wazuh detected repeated failed SSH authentication attempts originating from a Kali Linux attacker workstation against a monitored Ubuntu Server. The activity included multiple username attempts, which indicated password guessing rather than normal user error.

No successful authentication was identified during the investigation. The incident was classified as a medium-severity credential access attempt and closed after confirming that no compromise, persistence, or privilege escalation occurred.

INCIDENT DETAILS

Field	Value
Incident ID	IR-2026-002
Title	SSH Brute Force Detection
Category	Credential Access
Severity	Medium
Status	Closed
SIEM Platform	Wazuh
Source Host	Kali Linux attacker workstation
Source IP	192.168.56.104
Target Host	Ubuntu Server / LINUX01
Protocol	SSH
Lab Environment	VirtualBox Home Lab

INVESTIGATION TIMELINE

Time / Phase	Event
17:07:51	Initial failed SSH login detected against the monitored Ubuntu target endpoint.
Repeated Attempts	Additional failed SSH authentication attempts observed from the same source host.
Username Changes	Authentication attempts included usernames such as clinton, administrator, and testuser.
Alert Review	Wazuh alerts and Linux authentication activity were reviewed for evidence of successful access.
Closure	No successful login, persistence, privilege escalation, or lateral movement activity was identified.

INDICATORS OF COMPROMISE

Indicator	Value
Source IP	192.168.56.104
Source System	Kali Linux attacker workstation
Target System	Ubuntu Server / LINUX01
Protocol	SSH
Usernames Attempted	clinton, administrator, testuser
Activity Type	Multiple failed authentication attempts
Result	No successful authentication identified

MITRE ATT&CK MAPPING

Tactic	Technique	ID	Reason Applied
Credential Access	Brute Force - Password Guessing	T1110.001	The attacker attempted repeated SSH authentication using multiple usernames.

ANALYST INVESTIGATION

Review of the Wazuh alerts and Linux authentication activity showed repeated failed login attempts from a single source host. The use of multiple usernames increased confidence that the activity was malicious password guessing rather than a normal user mistyping a password.

The investigation did not identify any successful SSH login from the attacker system. No follow-on activity, privilege escalation, persistence, or lateral movement was observed after the failed authentication attempts.

CONTAINMENT AND RESPONSE

- Monitor or block the source IP address if activity continues.
- Review SSH access policy and restrict unnecessary remote login access.
- Enable Fail2Ban or similar lockout controls for repeated authentication failures.
- Require strong passwords or SSH key authentication for administrative access.
- Continue monitoring for successful authentication from the same source or related hosts.

RECOVERY

No recovery actions were required because the attacker did not successfully authenticate or gain access to the target system.

LESSONS LEARNED

Repeated failed logins from a single source, especially when multiple usernames are targeted, should be treated as suspicious and investigated quickly. Even unsuccessful brute-force attempts provide useful evidence for validating monitoring coverage and improving authentication controls.

SKILLS DEMONSTRATED

- Wazuh SIEM alert analysis
- Linux authentication log review
- SSH brute-force detection
- MITRE ATT&CK mapping
- Indicator of compromise identification
- Incident response documentation
- Home lab security monitoring

REFERENCES

- MITRE ATT&CK: Brute Force - Password Guessing (T1110.001)
- Wazuh documentation: Security monitoring and Linux agent alerting
- Ubuntu Linux authentication logs and SSH event analysis